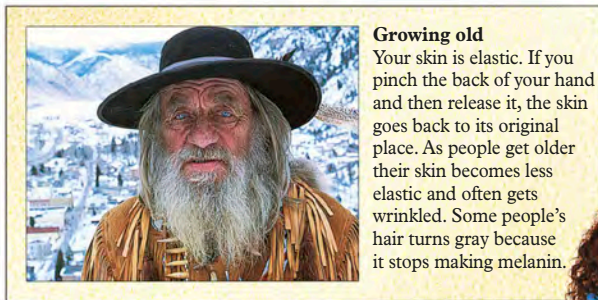


Shades

All skin contains a coloring substance called melanin. Dark skin contains more melanin than fair skin. As a protection from burning by the sun, the skin produces more melanin, which tans the skin a darker color.



The roots of your hair are alive and grow about 0.08 inches (two millimeters) a week. When the hairs reach the surface of your skin they die—so having your hair cut does not hurt!



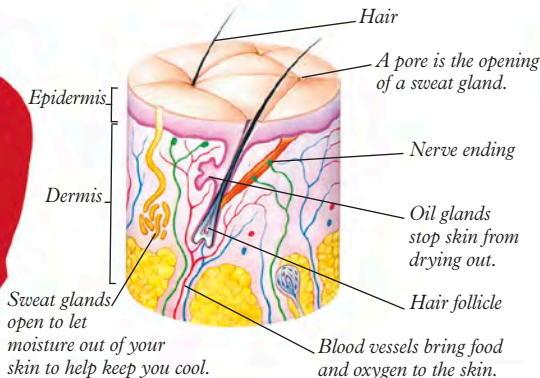
Growing old

Your skin is elastic. If you pinch the back of your hand and then release it, the skin goes back to its original place. As people get older their skin becomes less elastic and often gets wrinkled. Some people's hair turns gray because it stops making melanin.



Dead or alive?

Your skin has two layers. The dead, outer layer, called the epidermis, protects the living dermis underneath.



Hair styles

How straight or curly a hair is depends upon the shape of the pocket, or follicle, it grows from. The color of your hair depends upon the amount of black or red melanin there is inside these pockets.